SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #118 · THE END TIMES

# “I could be left behind because I’m not good enough.”

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## Where it often comes from

Movies and books about being left behind. Childhood panic when family members could not be found. Teaching that your behavior determines whether you will be taken. Shame about sin. Anxiety about salvation. Christians hold different views about the order of end-times events, but the deeper fear here is about being rejected by God.

## What Scripture teaches

Whatever view of the end times you hold, Scripture is clear that believers are kept by God, not by being good enough. God has not appointed us to suffer wrath but to obtain salvation through Jesus. No one can snatch Christ’s sheep out of His hand. There is no condemnation for those in Christ Jesus. John wrote so that believers may know they have eternal life. Your place with Christ rests on His goodness, not yours.

> *“For God has not appointed us to suffer wrath, but to obtain salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ. He died for us so that, whether we are awake or asleep, we may live together with Him”* **(1 Thessalonians 5:9–10)**.

## Also see

> “I give them eternal life, and they will never perish. No one can snatch them out of My hand. My Father who has given them to Me is greater than all. No one can snatch them out of My Father’s hand” **(John 10:28–29)**.

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” **(Romans 8:1)**.

> “I have written these things to you who believe in the name of the Son of God, so that you may know that you have eternal life” **(1 John 5:13)**.

> “For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, not by works, so that no one can boast” **(Ephesians 2:8–9)**.

## Common self-statements

- When Jesus comes, I’ll be left behind.
- I’m not holy enough to be taken.
- I panic when I can’t find my family.
- One sin could make me miss it.
- I have to be good enough to be ready.
- God will leave me because of my failures.

## Common logical errors

- **Catastrophizing:** Imagining being abandoned by God at His return.
- **Performance-based thinking:** Believing your readiness depends on being good enough.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel unworthy, so I will be rejected.”
- **Discounting God’s promises:** Overlooking promises that believers are kept by Christ.

## Challenging questions

- What has God appointed believers to, according to 1 Thessalonians 5:9?
- Can anyone snatch me out of Jesus' hand?
- Is there condemnation for those in Christ?
- Does my salvation rest on my goodness or Christ's?
- Why did John write 1 John 5:13?
- Where did this fear first come from?
- Have I trusted Jesus as my Savior?

## Truth summary

> I will not be left behind because I'm not good enough. My salvation rests on Jesus, not my goodness. God has not appointed me to wrath but to salvation through Christ. No one can snatch me out of His hand, and there is no condemnation for me in Him. I can know that I have eternal life.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Second Coming
- Salvation
- End Times
- Fear
- Eternal Life

## Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

**Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I could be left behind because I'm not good enough"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

**Name:** _____ **Date started:** _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

**"I could be left behind because I'm not good enough."** I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What has God appointed believers to?
- ☐ Can anyone snatch me from Jesus' hand?
- ☐ Is there condemnation for me in Christ?
- ☐ Does my salvation rest on my goodness?
- ☐ Why did John write 1 John 5:13?
- ☐ Have I trusted Jesus as my Savior?

**My own question:** _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ God has appointed me to salvation, not wrath.
- ☐ No one can snatch me out of Jesus' hand.
- ☐ My place with Christ rests on His goodness.
- ☐ There is no condemnation for me in Christ.
- ☐ I can know that I have eternal life.
- ☐ I am saved by grace, not by being good enough.

**In my own words:** _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 5:9–10**
  *"For God has not appointed us to suffer wrath, but to obtain salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ. He died for us so that, whether we are awake or asleep, we may live together with Him."*
- [ ] **John 10:28–29**
  *"I give them eternal life, and they will never perish. No one can snatch them out of My hand. My Father who has given them to Me is greater than all. No one can snatch them out of My Father's hand."*
- [ ] **Romans 8:1**
  *"Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."*
- [ ] **1 John 5:13**
  *"I have written these things to you who believe in the name of the Son of God, so that you may know that you have eternal life."*
- [ ] **Ephesians 2:8–9**
  *"For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, not by works, so that no one can boast."*

**A verse I found myself:** _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Secure in Christ log:** When fear comes, write one promise that I belong to Jesus.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, John 10:28 becomes: "I give **Sarah** eternal life, and **she** will never perish. No one can snatch **her** out of My hand."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Salvation" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

- ☐ **Write the date you trusted Christ,** or pray now to trust Him, and keep it where you can see it.
- ☐ **Read 1 Thessalonians 4:13–5:11,** and underline every word of comfort.
- ☐ **If you panic when you can't find family,** pause, breathe slowly, and repeat John 10:28 before taking action.
- ☐ **Talk with a pastor or counselor** about fears that started in childhood.

**What I will do:** _____

**When:** _____

**What the lie predicts will happen:** _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

**What actually happened:** _____

What I learned: _____

**The lie** "I could be left behind because I'm not good enough": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | One promise that I belong to Jesus |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I could be left behind because I'm not good enough.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord Jesus, thank You that my place with You rests on Your goodness, not mine. Help me reject the fear that I could be left behind because I'm not good enough. Thank You that no one can snatch me out of Your hand and that I can look forward to Your return with hope. In Your name, Amen.*

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*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*